

Tecno Phantom V Fold

The cheapest foldable, but is it worth the price?

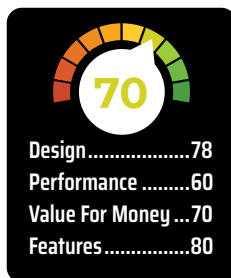
Tecno Phantom V Fold 5G at pretty much half the price of the industry leader sounds like a sweet deal. However, is the phone designed well, is the software well-optimised, how does the phone perform, and how are the cameras? These are some of the questions I'll answer in my review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Tecno Phantom V Fold 5G is built extremely well for its price. The rear panel is resistant to fingerprints and smudges. The crease of the inner screen is minimal due to Tecno's 'Drop-Hinge'. The buttons are nice and tactile. However, the side-mounted fingerprint sensor is extremely sensitive. The camera island on the back is large and circular, and it may not be to everyone's taste. At 299 g, it is one of the heaviest foldables on the market right now.

DISPLAY(S)

The inner foldable display measures a whopping 7.85 inches – the largest foldable screen in the Indian market right now. The display sports 2K+ resolution (2296x2000 pixels). Both its displays have Adaptive refresh rate with support to switch from 10 Hz - 120 Hz, as per the usage. Both displays do not come with HDR certification, which is extremely disappointing for a premium smartphone. During my testing I got a maximum reading of 802 nits on the inner display and 815 nits on the cover display in bright sunlight on Auto-Brightness. What it provides is more than adequate for screen legibility in all situations. Both the screens look great – the colours are not the most accurate but look vivid and pleasing and the detail is good as well. However, the viewing angles are mediocre at this price.



PERFORMANCE

Tecno Phantom V Fold scored 992328 in AnTuTu – the highest amongst every other foldable I tested against this phone. In Geekbench though, both the Samsung foldables beat the Phantom V Fold in both the Single Core and Multi Core tests. However,

the V Fold did soundly beat the OPPO foldable. I ran the CPU Throttling Test on the V Fold 5G to see how it would perform under sustained workloads and it dropped to 76 per cent of its peak performance in just 15 minutes. The Phantom V Fold didn't impress me as much in the GPU benchmarks. The phone consistently got lower scores than the two Samsung foldables and the N2 Flip in all GPU benchmarks. The phone runs HiOS 13 Fold based on Android 13. It's all well-implemented and intuitive, so it won't take too long to learn the actions that trigger these modes. There are some bugs that hopefully are solved soon.

CAMERA

The primary camera's pictures taken in daylight look crisp and detailed, plus they have good dynamic range and fairly natural colour as well. Close-up images look great as well. Portraits taken from

the main camera have good colours and edge detection. However, I noticed a sharp decline in quality in telephoto portraits where the 2x zoom levels are engaged. Ultrawide images are decent but nowhere near flagship level. The ultrawide camera also doubles as a macro shooter which takes surprisingly usable and good-looking shots. Low-light photos also have plenty of detail when taken from the main camera. Noise is kept to a minimum as well. Selfies are decent from the inner screen, there's a bit of softness but in ideal lighting conditions, you can get decent shots. The outer selfie camera is better. But, the best selfie shots are taken from the primary lens.

BATTERY LIFE

The Tecno Phantom V Fold 5G impressed us with its battery life. If you're a light user, you're looking at a minimum of a day and a half of battery life. And if you are more of an intensive, heavy user, prepare to charge up the device at night, when you're preparing to go to sleep. As for charging, during my testing, the phone charged from 0-100 in 1 hour and 12 minutes, and reached the 62 per cent mark in half an hour.

VERDICT

For the company's first attempt at a foldable – the Tecno Phantom V Fold 5G is a good value proposition for those wanting to experience a phablet-style foldable at half the cost of the industry leader. However, the phone does falter in some areas – the software, while well-implemented in the grand scheme of things, does have some bugs, and the performance (especially gaming) isn't the best at this premium price.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 7.85" 2K+120Hz LTPO Display | 6.42" FHD+Sub-display | Dual LTPO AMOLED | Battery: 5000mAh battery | 45W in-box Charger | Storage: 256/512GB UFS 3.1 | RAM: Up to 21GB LPDDR5x RAM | Weight: 299.01 grams | Chipset: Mediatek Dimensity 9000+ | Battery: Li-Po 5000 mAh | Colors: Black, White

CONTACT

Phone: N/A | Email: Web Form | Website: <https://www.mobile-phantom.com/homepage>